

Dear department IQ Health and department of Medical Imaging,

My name is Varvara Lazarenko, and I would like to express my interest in applying for a PhD position in Early health technology assessment (HTA) of oncologic innovations in radionuclide therapy.

From the moment I discovered this position, I felt it aligned perfectly with my experience and career aspirations to address the societal issues of the healthcare system. As a 2024 graduate of the Medical Biology master's program with a specialization in Science, Management & Innovation (SMI) from Radboud University, I am passionate about advancing healthcare in a more sustainable and cost-effective way, ultimately benefiting patients, medical professionals, innovators, and society overall. That is why I am thrilled about this opportunity to delve into the early HTA research on oncology innovations, assessing the potential added value of radionuclide therapy.

My academic background equips me with a solid foundation for this role. Having finished a bachelor's in Biology and a master's in Medical Biology, I gained extensive knowledge in the field and developed a critical understanding of various pharmaceuticals (including state-of-the-art oncology therapeutics), medical technologies, and biomedical challenges. During the SMI track in the second year of my master's, I also gained valuable insights into the HTA, digital healthcare, sustainability goals, and health economics. Additionally, my experience as a mentor for first-year students during much of my academic journey has reinforced my passion for sharing knowledge, so I am also excited about the opportunity to engage in teaching activities.

My professional experience will also be an asset for this PhD position. As a Junior Research Assistant at the Faculty of Biology and an assistant at a Contract Research Organization, I gained substantial experience in writing academic papers and reports, designing experiments, preparing clinical documentation, and analyzing different types of data. These roles significantly deepened my understanding of the healthcare and pharmaceutical industries.

Besides, my master's thesis at HAN University of Applied Sciences provided me with valuable experience in both qualitative (interviews) and quantitative (surveys, cost-effectiveness analysis) methods of social science research. It involved analysis of the added value of home telemonitoring technology via the HTA framework presented onto the Quadruple aim, and included working with elderly patients and medical professionals. Moreover, it gave me experience in conducting some parts of the thesis in Dutch, which further fuelled me to actively learn the language. Furthermore, during my SMI track, I worked on real-world projects such as "HTA of a Medical Guidance App for International Students in the NL" and "A Shared Ownership Model of the Green Corridor." All these experiences greatly enriched my understanding of stakeholder collaboration and honed my skills in presenting and engaging audiences effectively.

To sum up, I believe that my strong motivation for HTA research, combined with my comprehensive education and diverse professional experiences, positions me as a strong candidate for this PhD position. I am confident that this opportunity will bring me closer to my final academic and career goals – towards the future of an expert in connecting science and society.

Thank you for considering my application and, in case any questions arise, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Kind regards,
Varvara Lazarenko